



Hollerith tabulator

1889

Hollerith tabulator

The electrical tabulating machine invented by Herman Hollerith in the US is the first device to use punched cards to store data rather than control a process.

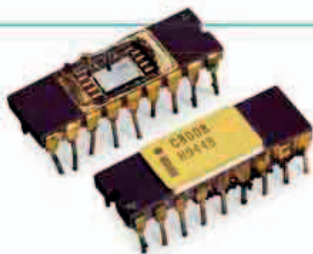


Pocket calculator

1960s

Electronic calculator

Electronic desktop calculators emerge in the 1960s with the invention of the transistor. Pocket calculators soon follow.



Microchip

1970s

Microprocessor chips

Integrated circuits containing thousands of transistors become commercially available for use in computers.

1822

Babbage's Difference Engine

Charles Babbage begins work on the design of a machine capable of complex calculations.

1939

The Bombe

Based on a Polish design, this electromechanical device is built in Britain during World War II to decipher codes.

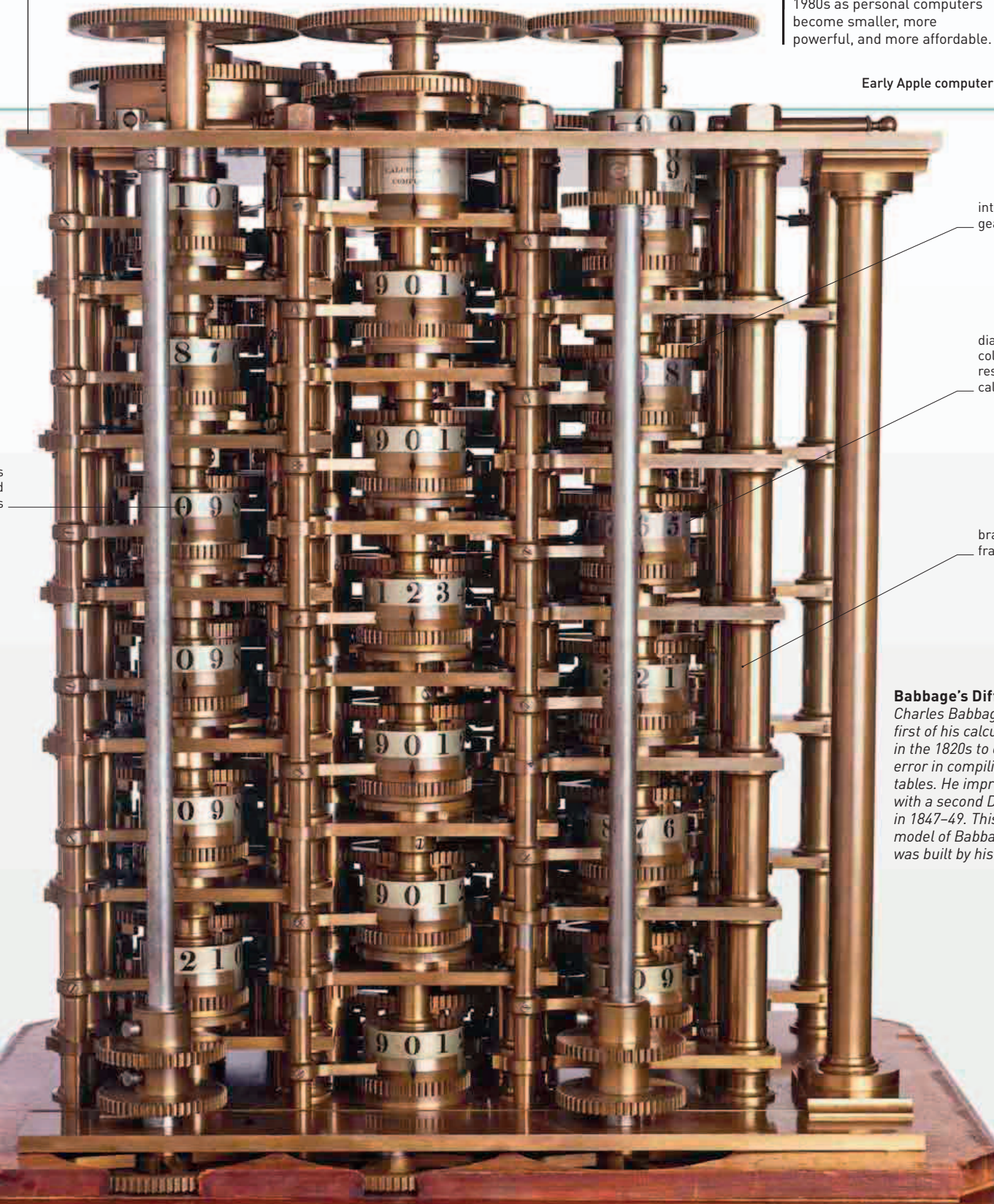
1980s-present

Personal computers

The so-called "microcomputer revolution" takes off in the 1980s as personal computers become smaller, more powerful, and more affordable.



Early Apple computer



figures
engraved
on wheels

interconnected
gear wheels

dial on final
column shows
result of
calculation

brass
framework

Babbage's Difference Engine

Charles Babbage designed the first of his calculating machines in the 1820s to overcome human error in compiling numerical tables. He improved on the design with a second Difference Engine in 1847-49. This demonstration model of Babbage's first design was built by his son Henry.